parentkeeping

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Caregiver Checklists

for the family caring for Mom or Dad

01 Caregiver Daily Checklist

02 30 Questions to Ask Aging Parents

03 Finances & Documents Checklist

04 Caregiver Self-Care Checklist

Checklists are easier to share

than worries are.

How to Use These Checklists

Four pages. Print what you need, or type straight into the PDF.

1. **Caregiver Daily Checklist (page 3)**
   Print a week of copies and keep them with the medication chart. Whoever is on duty ticks what's done and writes one line for the next helper. At the end of the week you can see how things are going without a single phone call.

2. **30 Questions to Ask Aging Parents (page 4)**
   Don't cover everything at once. Pick one area per visit: health first, then daily life, money, home and wishes. Listen more than you talk, and write the answers down while you have them.

3. **Finances & Documents Checklist (page 5)**
   Find each paper and write down where it is kept. Never write passwords, PINs or account numbers on this page.

4. **Caregiver Self-Care Checklist (page 6)**
   A weekly check on you, because the person doing the caring counts too. Do it on Sunday evening, before the week starts again.

> **Share the load**
> Once a checklist exists, each sibling can take a section. Copy the jobs onto the "Who does what" page of the Medical Binder, or the Job Board in the Shared Family Care Sheet.

> **About these checklists**
> General information only. Every family's situation is different, so check with the professionals involved in your parent's care.

Disclaimer

Parentkeeping products, including printables, fillable PDFs, Google Sheets, checklists, quizzes and articles, are organizing tools for families. They are for general information and personal record-keeping only.

They are not medical, legal, financial, tax or mental health advice, and they do not replace advice from a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, attorney, financial adviser or other qualified professional who knows your family's situation. Always follow the instructions of your parent's doctors and pharmacist. Never start, stop or change a medication or dose based on anything in a Parentkeeping product.

You are responsible for the accuracy of the information you record and for keeping it up to date and private. Parentkeeping is not a medical record, a care provider or a legal service, and using our products does not create any professional relationship.

In an emergency, call 911 or your local emergency number.

NAME _____ DATE _____

Caregiver Daily Checklist

One page per day. Tick what's done; leave a note for the next helper.

Morning

- [ ] Up, washed and dressed
- [ ] Breakfast
- [ ] A drink: water, tea or juice
- [ ] Morning medicines, as listed on the medication chart (initial the chart)
- [ ] Asked how they slept and how they feel

NOTE _____

Midday

- [ ] Lunch
- [ ] Another drink
- [ ] Moved around or a short walk
- [ ] Appointments or calls handled

NOTE _____

Afternoon

- [ ] Snack
- [ ] Another drink
- [ ] An activity or a visitor
- [ ] Mail and bills checked

NOTE _____

Evening

- [ ] Dinner
- [ ] Evening medicines, as listed on the medication chart (initial the chart)
- [ ] Doors locked, night light on
- [ ] Glasses, phone and hearing aids within reach

NOTE _____

MOOD TODAY ☐ Good ☐ OK ☐ Low ☐ Unsettled

SLEPT ☐ Well ☐ So-so ☐ Badly

ANYTHING NEW OR UNUSUAL TO MENTION TO THE DOCTOR

HANDOVER FOR TOMORROW'S HELPER

30 Questions to Ask Aging Parents

One area per visit. Tick each one you've talked about.

HEALTH

- [ ] 1 Who are all your doctors, and what does each one see you for?
- [ ] 2 Which medicines and supplements do you take, and who prescribed them?
- [ ] 3 Which pharmacy do you use?
- [ ] 4 What worries you most about your health right now?
- [ ] 5 Have you had any falls or dizzy spells lately?
- [ ] 6 Who would you like with you at appointments, if anyone?

DAILY LIFE

- [ ] 7 What has got harder in the last year?
- [ ] 8 What help would you be glad to accept?
- [ ] 9 What do you want to keep doing yourself, no matter what?
- [ ] 10 How are you sleeping and eating these days?
- [ ] 11 How do you feel about driving?
- [ ] 12 Who do you see or talk to in a normal week?

MONEY

- [ ] 13 Where do you bank, and is there an account we don't know about?
- [ ] 14 Which bills come each month, and how do you pay them?
- [ ] 15 Is anything set up on auto-pay?
- [ ] 16 Who helps you with your taxes?
- [ ] 17 Would you like one of us to help keep an eye on the accounts?
- [ ] 18 Who should we call if something looks wrong?

NOTES

HOME

- [ ] 19 Do you want to stay in this house as long as you can?
- [ ] 20 What would make the house easier or safer to live in?
- [ ] 21 Who has a spare key?
- [ ] 22 Which neighbors or friends check in on you?
- [ ] 23 If you couldn't live alone, where would you want to be?
- [ ] 24 Is there a repair or job you've been putting off?

WISHES & DOCUMENTS

- [ ] 25 Do you have a will, and where is it kept?
- [ ] 26 Who did you name as power of attorney, for money and for health?
- [ ] 27 Do you have an advance directive or living will?
- [ ] 28 Is there anything you'd want your doctors to know about your wishes?
- [ ] 29 Who should we call first in an emergency?
- [ ] 30 What matters most to you about how you're cared for?

ANSWERS WORTH WRITING DOWN

Finances & Documents Checklist

Find each one before you need it, and write down where it lives.

Never write passwords, PINs or account numbers here
Record where things are kept, not what's in them.

ITEM	FOUND IT	WHERE IT'S KEPT	NOTES
Bank and credit card accounts (names only)	☐		
Regular bills and due dates	☐		
Social Security and pension details	☐		
Medicare and insurance cards	☐		
Tax returns and who prepares them	☐		
Will	☐		
Trust documents	☐		
Financial power of attorney	☐		
Healthcare power of attorney / proxy	☐		
Advance directive / living will	☐		
Property deed or lease	☐		
Car title and insurance	☐		
Online accounts list (stored securely)	☐		
Safe deposit box and key	☐		
	☐		
	☐		

Tip: keep originals somewhere safe and copies in the Medical Binder. Your parent's attorney or bank can tell you which documents they need to see.

NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

Caregiver Self-Care Checklist

A weekly check on you. The person doing the caring counts too.

EVERY DAY	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Slept most of the night	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Ate real meals	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Moved my body	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Had a few minutes that were just mine	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

THIS WEEK

- ☐ Talked to a friend, not about caregiving
- ☐ Asked for help with one specific thing
- ☐ Kept my own medical appointments
- ☐ Said no to one thing

ONE THING THAT WENT WELL

ONE THING I NEED HELP WITH

HOW AM I DOING, HONESTLY? ☐ Steady ☐ Stretched ☐ Running on empty

PEOPLE I CAN CALL WHEN IT'S A LOT

NAME	PHONE	GOOD FOR (A WALK, A MEAL, AN HOUR OFF…)

If it's too much
If you feel overwhelmed, talk to your doctor or a counselor. If you are in crisis or thinking about harming yourself, contact a crisis line now: in the US call or text **988**; in the UK and Ireland call Samaritans on **116 123**; elsewhere find your local line at **findahelpline.com**. In an emergency, call your local emergency number.

The checklists are the start.

Sharing the work is the next step.

These pages help you see what needs doing. The Family Care System gives it one place to live, and a way to share the work, and the costs, fairly between siblings.

THE PARENTKEEPING FAMILY CARE SYSTEM

Your parent's care, kept in one place. And shared fairly.

- **Medical Binder for an Elderly Parent**
  64 pages for medications, doctors, appointments and paperwork.
- **Shared Family Care Sheet**
  One Google Sheet with a job board, a rota and a cost tracker showing each sibling's share.
- **Family Meeting Kit**
  An agenda and what to say for the first sibling conversation.
- **Family Caregiver Agreement Template**
  To write down paid or unpaid care, then take to an elder-law attorney.

See the Family Care System

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Make it a habit. Ten minutes on Sunday: look at the week's daily checklists, tick your self-care page, and decide one thing to hand to someone else.

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Your parent's care, kept in one place. And shared fairly.

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General information only. Check with the professionals involved in your parent's care.